

Recollection of the Heart of All the Tathāgatas

Sarvatathatāgatahṛdayānusmṛti · Toh 537 · Derge Kangyur

ད་བཞུགས་གསལ་པ་སྤྱི་སྒྲི་པ་རྣམས་ཀྱི་ཡི་མཚན་པ།

Toh 537 in the Kangyur is a short dhāraṇī or mantra text known in Sanskrit as the Tathāgata-hṛdaya, meaning "The Heart of the Tathāgata," and in Tibetan as De bzhin gshegs pa spyi'i snying po. It belongs to the class of dhāraṇī literature and presents a series of sacred mantras associated with the Tathāgatas and specific buddhas, most notably the Buddha Ratnasikhin (the Jewel-Crested One), together with the spiritual benefits conferred by their recitation, such as the purification of vast karmic obscurations and liberation from rebirth in lower realms. The text is compact in form, consisting primarily of mantra formulas accompanied by brief prose statements extolling their efficacy, a structure typical of canonical dhāraṇī collections. It is found in the Kangyur, the Tibetan canon of buddhavaṇana, or words of the Buddha, and represents the kind of practical devotional material that circulated widely in Indian and Tibetan Buddhist communities.

Tathāgata-hṛdaya, anugate, oṃ kuruṃ gini svāhā.

Even a single recitation of this mantra will purify the karmic obscurations accumulated over eight thousand hundred-thousandfold eons. Here ends the complete recollection of the heart of all the Tathāgatas.

Homage to the Buddha Ratnasikhin (the Jewel-Crested One). Namo ratnaśikhine, tathāgatāya, arhate samyakṣambuddhāya. Tadyathā: ratne ratne ratnaśikhine svāhā.

Whoever remembers this mantra at the moment of death will be fully liberated from all the lower realms. Moreover, after passing away, one will be born among the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

Concerning the Buddha Ratnasikhin —

Translator's Notes

- The passage consists primarily of Sanskrit dhāraṇī syllables transliterated into Tibetan script, rendered here in their reconstructed Sanskrit form. "The Heaven of the Thirty-Three" refers to Trāyastriṃśa, the realm of Śakra (Indra) on the summit of Mount Meru. The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end, indicating this is a fragment; the following portion presumably continues the account of Ratnasikhin's virtues or powers.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.